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TRACK A · AI FOUNDATIONS · KIT 3 OF 20

AI for Planning & Differentiation

Word-for-Word Facilitator Script: read it aloud exactly as written, or make it your own. Keyed to all 35 slides, with stage directions, a running clock, and answers to the questions staff actually ask.

Facilitator Script · 45–60 minutes

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi
A husband-and-wife team of certified educators with over 20 combined years in the classroom. Adam is a certified CTE Carpentry teacher; Katelyn is a certified K-8 teacher.

How to use this script

Everything in plain type is meant to be spoken aloud. Read it verbatim (it's written for the ear) or glance and paraphrase once you're comfortable. Either way delivers a complete session. Slide cues, stage directions, and question boxes work exactly as they did in Kits 1 and 2. Run those kits first: this session assumes the two permanent rules (no student PII in public tools; a human reviews everything) and the four-part prompt formula (role, task, context, format). One prep item is non-negotiable: staff must bring one upcoming lesson. The lab is built on it.

> **Meet Ms. Rivera.** Throughout the deck you'll see the same example teacher's screen: Ms. Rivera, our running composite (not a real person; she appears in every kit). When her screen is up, point the room at it; it's the model to mimic in the lab. If someone asks who she is, say exactly that: a fictional teacher we use across the series so you always see what the work looks like before you try it yourself. Her tracker chip sits top-right on every slide; the matching line under each slide cue below tells you what it says, so you always know what the room is reading.

Timing checkpoints

Clock	You should be...	If behind...
0:12	Starting the toolkit (slide 10)	Trim discussion on slides 6–8
0:24	Starting the 4-point review (slide 16)	Compress moves 3 and 4 to one minute each
0:30	Starting the lab (slide 19)	Start it anyway; the lab is the session
0:53	On First 48 Hours (slide 32)	Hold the closing lines; hand out sheets at the door

45-minute version: in the lab, differentiate one direction instead of two, take two share-out voices instead of four, and read the "45-min cut" stage notes where they appear.

From the founders

⟶ *This note is from Adam and Katelyn Spinozzi, the two certified teachers who wrote this kit. It's here to give you their perspective before you present. Sharing it is entirely your call: read parts aloud where they fit, retell them in your own words, or keep it to yourself as background. The session is complete either way.*

We're Adam and Katelyn, and here is why this session matters for what happens in your classrooms: differentiation is one of the few things in education that works and that nobody could actually afford to do. The research says materials have to genuinely differ; the week says three hand-built versions of everything is impossible. Every teacher lives in that gap, and every teacher has quietly triaged a student's version away because the hours ran out. AI is the first tool we've seen that closes the gap for real: the drafting that made differentiation unsustainable now costs minutes. That changes who gets reached in your room, and that's why this hour exists.

The lessons we believe this hour will leave with your staff: a planning workflow where AI drafts and the teacher decides; the moves that turn one solid lesson into leveled, scaffolded, and stretched versions in minutes; a four-point review that keeps quality and judgment in the room; and a position we hold plainly, that in practice equity tends to favor the struggling child, and the top of the class is usually the version that gets cut. That's not a criticism of anyone's intentions; it's what triage looks like when materials are hand-built. Now that drafting an extension costs minutes instead of an evening, build the stretch on purpose.

Segment 1 · Welcome & the differentiation dilemma (slides 1–4)

SLIDE 1 Title — 0:00

⟶ *Slide 1 up as people arrive. Start on time.*

Welcome back. Kit 1 gave us the rules of the road. Kit 2 gave us the formula: role, task, context, format. Today the formula goes to work on the hardest everyday problem in teaching: the fact that the students in your room are not all the same student. This session is about planning and differentiation, and it ends with you holding a real artifact for a real lesson you're about to teach.

SLIDE 2 The dilemma — 0:01

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her dilemma: differentiation worked when she managed it; the hours didn't exist.

Let's name the dilemma honestly, both halves. Half one: differentiation works. A large meta-analysis by Deunk and colleagues found small-to-moderate positive effects on achievement, and the effects were strongest when differentiation was embedded in a bigger instructional program and supported by technology. Just sorting kids into groups isn't enough; the materials have to actually differ. Half two: making the materials differ was never humanly sustainable. Three versions of every text, every practice set, every station? Nobody was failing at that out of laziness. The plan asked for more hours than the week has.

SLIDE 3 Why now 0:03

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her time math changed: the drafting help finally arrived.

Here's why this session exists now and not five years ago. As of late 2025, 61 percent of teachers were using AI in their work, up from 34 percent just two years earlier; that's from Education Week's research center. And what are they using it for? Creating lesson plans and student resources sits among the most common uses. The Gallup teacher survey adds the part that matters: among teachers who use AI for a given task, like preparing lessons or modifying materials to student levels, 60 to 84 percent say it saves them time, and weekly users save around six hours a week. The tool that attacks the time problem specifically has arrived. Today we point it at differentiation.

SLIDE 4 Agenda + one promise 0:04

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her goal: one artifact, three versions, reviewed, teachable this week.

The hour: first, the planning workflow, where AI fits and where it absolutely doesn't. Then the toolkit: four differentiation moves with prompts you can copy tonight. Then quality control, because a leveled text that isn't actually at level is worse than none. And then the heart of the session: you bring the lesson you were asked to bring, and you leave with one fully differentiated artifact for it. Core version, a support version, an extension, reviewed and ready to teach. That's the promise. Not examples. Your lesson.

Segment 2 · The planning workflow (slides 5–9)

SLIDE 5 Never from scratch again 0:05

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her stance: never from a blank page again. Skeleton drafted, judgment hers.

Here's the stance for today, and it fits in one breath: never from scratch again. Not "never plan again." Never start from a blank page again. The blank page was always the most expensive part of planning, and it was never the part that needed your expertise. AI drafts the skeleton. You supply the judgment. Same five words as always: AI drafts, the teacher decides.

SLIDE 6 The 30-minute lesson plan 0:07

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her expectation: a 30-minute draft, and at least one invented thing to catch.

Let me show you the best study we have on exactly this. Two researchers, Powell and Courchesne, published in PLOS ONE, sat down with ChatGPT and asked it to plan a first grade science lesson. In about 30 minutes of drafting and refining, they had a standards-aligned lesson plan. Thirty minutes. That's the good news, and it's real. Now the other half, from the same study: along the way, the drafts included questionable components, missing details, and one resource that did not exist. The AI recommended it confidently. It was fabricated.

SLIDE 7 Both halves are true

0:09

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her review habit: that's where her expertise enters the document.

Hold both halves of that study at once, because both are true. The 30 minutes is real: a working skeleton, aligned to standards, in the time it takes to eat lunch. And the fabricated resource is real too, which is why review is non-negotiable. Not review as a formality. Review as the step where the actual teaching expertise enters the document. The study's authors reached the same conclusion we teach in every kit: this workflow needs a professional in the loop, and that professional is you.

SLIDE 8 The UDL frame: generate options

0:10

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her UDL frame: AI generates the menu; she orders for her class.

One frame makes AI genuinely useful for planning instead of just fast, and it comes from Universal Design for Learning, the CAST guidelines, now in version 3.0. UDL says: design with multiple means from the start. Multiple ways to engage, multiple ways to represent the content, multiple ways for students to show what they know. A meta-analysis by Capp found UDL an effective methodology for improving learning across the board. Here's the connection: generating options was always UDL's cost problem, and generating options is the single thing AI does fastest. So the move is: ask for options in bulk, then choose like the professional who knows the room. AI generates the menu. You order for your class.

> **If asked "is this just learning styles again?"** No, and the distinction matters. UDL doesn't sort students into types; it builds flexibility into the materials so every student has a workable path. The research base we cite is about options and access, not matching lessons to labels.

SLIDE 9 The workflow on one slide

0:11

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her workflow: draft, then options, then pick and adapt, then review.

So the planning workflow, four steps. One: draft. Use the Kit 2 formula to get the core artifact. Two: options. Ask the AI to vary it: levels, scaffolds, formats. Three: pick and adapt, because you know which option fits which kid, and the AI never will. Four: review, with a four-point checklist we'll learn before the lab. Draft, options, pick, review. That's the whole system.

Segment 3 · The differentiation toolkit: four moves (slides 10–15)

SLIDE 10 Four moves

0:12

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her four moves: level it, scaffold it, stretch it, reformat it.

The toolkit is four moves, and every differentiated classroom you've ever admired runs on some mix of them. Level it: the same text at different reading levels. Scaffold it: supports that let a student climb to the same target. Stretch it: depth for students who finish in four minutes. Reformat it: the same content in a different shape. If you want the research pedigree, this is Tomlinson's classic frame: differentiate by readiness, by interest, by learning profile. The first three moves serve readiness. The fourth serves interest and profile. Nothing here is new pedagogy. What's new is the price.

SLIDE 11 Move 1: level it

0:14

Move one, the workhorse: leveled texts. One passage in, three reading levels out. Here's the prompt, and notice it's just the Kit 2 formula wearing work clothes: "You are a reading specialist. Rewrite the passage below at three levels: on-grade for 6th grade, about two years below, and about two years above. Keep every key idea, the section headings, and the same core vocabulary words. At the lower level, keep sentences under 12 words and add a 5-word vocabulary box with student-friendly definitions. At the higher level, keep the length similar but raise the complexity of the reasoning, not just the vocabulary. Label each version." Then paste your passage. Ninety seconds later you have three texts that used to cost you an evening.

SLIDE 12 Check the level, don't trust the label

0:16

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her level check: read aloud, eyeball sentence length, try on one student.

Now the habit that keeps move one honest: check the level, don't trust the label. The AI will happily stamp "3rd grade level" on whatever it produces. Sometimes it's right. You verify, and here's why verification is even possible: readability is genuinely measurable. Researchers led by Crossley built the CLEAR corpus, thousands of passages with reading-ease ratings grounded in teacher judgment, precisely because level is a real, testable property of a text, not a vibe. So test it, fast, three ways. Read a paragraph aloud: your ear knows your grade level. Eyeball the sentence length: if the "easier" version still runs 25-word sentences, it isn't easier. And the gold standard: try it on one actual student tomorrow and watch where they stumble. Two minutes of checking protects everything the leveling bought you.

SLIDE 13 Move 2: scaffold it

0:18

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her scaffold set: starters, word bank, worked example on a different topic.

Move two: scaffolds. Same task, same target, more handholds. The four scaffolds AI drafts well: sentence starters, word banks, worked examples, and the text for graphic organizers. On screen is Ms. Rivera's version of the prompt, filled in on the food webs passage she carries through this session, with the four parts colour-coded; your handout has the same prompt as a blank template. "You are a 6th grade science teacher. For the food webs passage below, create five sentence starters, a 10-word word bank, and one fully worked example paragraph. My students can explain a food web out loud and then freeze on the page. Keep the science exactly as the passage has it. One starter per paragraph, student-friendly definitions, and the worked example on a different topic, so students see the shape without copying the content." That last clause is the professional touch: a worked example on a different topic teaches the structure and keeps the thinking with the student.

SLIDE 14 Move 3: stretch it

0:20

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her stretch rule: depth, not more worksheets. Apply, critique, teach.

Move three: extension, and let's say the quiet rule out loud: early finishers get depth, not more of the same. A second worksheet is a punishment for being fast. On screen is Ms. Rivera's version, aimed at her food webs passage and colour-coded the same four ways; the handout carries the blank template. "You are a 6th grade science teacher. Create three extension prompts for students who have already mastered the food webs passage below. These are the students who finish in ten minutes. Go deeper, not longer, and no additional practice problems. One prompt that applies the idea to an unfamiliar context, one that asks them to critique a flawed example, and one that asks them to teach it to a younger student in their own words." Your strongest students stop being your most bored ones, and it cost you a minute.

SLIDE 15 Move 4: reformat it

0:22

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her reformat: same lesson as stations, cards, and a ramped practice set.

Move four: same content, different shape. This is the UDL move: multiple means, on demand. Take the lesson content you already have and ask, the way Ms. Rivera does on screen with her food webs content, four parts colour-coded, blank template on your handout: "You are a 6th grade science teacher. Turn the food webs content below into three formats. Same concepts and same vocabulary in all three, and label everything, so I can hand them out without re-reading them. A set of four station-activity directions. A deck of eight discussion cards, one question per card. A 10-item practice set that ramps from recall to application." One draft becomes a menu. Some days you'll use one format; some days three stations run at once. Either way, the version you never had time to make now exists.

Segment 4 · Quality control (slides 16–18)

SLIDE 16 The 4-point review 0:24

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her 4-point review: accurate, at level, fits her kids, sounds like her.

Before the lab, the checklist that stands between an AI draft and your students. Four points, every artifact, every time. One: accurate? Facts, examples, and any named resources checked; remember the fabricated resource in the PLOS ONE study. Two: at level, actually? Run the quick checks; don't trust the label. Three: fits your students? The AI wrote for a generic class; you teach a specific one. Swap the examples that won't land. Four: sounds like you? If the directions don't sound like your directions, students notice before you do. Accurate, at level, fits, sounds like you. Fail any point, fix it; that's the review.

SLIDE 17 Honest limits 0:26

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her honesty: the level label is a guess until she checks it.

The honest-limits minute, because trust lives here. AI does not know your kids. It has never met the student who shuts down at word problems or the one who reads two grades up but writes two grades down. Leveled is not the same as verified; the label is a guess until you check it. And it can invent things: activities that don't quite work, resources that don't exist. None of that is a reason to skip the tool. All of it is the reason the teacher stays in the loop. The drafting got fast. The deciding is still yours.

SLIDE 18 The equity note 0:28

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her equity move: build the stretch on purpose, not just the support.

One more thing before the lab, and it's bigger than this room. RAND found that in the 2023–24 school year, about a quarter of teachers were using AI for planning or teaching, and adoption lagged in higher-poverty schools. Sit with that: the schools whose students most need differentiated materials are the least likely to be getting AI's help making them. These tools should narrow gaps, not widen them. In this building, the way we make that true is simple: everyone learns the moves, everyone shares the prompts, and the differentiation reaches every roster, not just the early adopters'.

Segment 5 · The lab: differentiate your real lesson (slides 19–28)

SLIDE 19 Lab setup 0:30

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her lab pick, one artifact all the way through: her 6th grade food webs passage.

⟶ Devices out, pairs formed inside two minutes. Announce the tool. Anyone without a lesson borrows a partner's or uses next week's plan book. Energy up; this is the session.

Lab time, and today the material is yours: the upcoming lesson you brought. By the end of three steps you'll have a core artifact, a support version, and an extension, reviewed and teachable this week. Ms. Rivera builds hers on screen the whole way, one artifact all the way through: the reading passage for her 6th grade food webs lesson. You'll see all of it, the passage she starts with, the prompt she types, every follow-up she makes, and the finished set. If you ever feel lost, copy her structure. Ground rules ride along: no student information in the prompt, ever. Describe needs, not names: "students reading below grade level," never a child. And nothing goes to a student until the 4-point review says so.

SLIDE 20 Lab step 1: draft the core 0:33

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR On her screen big: her food webs passage, drafted to 80%, not polished.

⟶ 5 minutes. Circulate. Weak drafts usually lack context; nudge with "what would a substitute need to know about this lesson?"

Step one: draft the core artifact with the Kit 2 formula. Pick the one artifact your lesson most needs: the reading, the practice set, the directions, the exit check. Role, task, context, format, and be generous with context: grade, topic, what students just learned, what they always trip on. Run it, read it like an editor, and get it to eighty percent. Don't polish; the next step is where today's session earns its name.

SLIDE 21 Her starting artifact, in full 0:35

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her starting artifact, in full: the on-grade food webs passage she will differentiate.

⟶ Leave this up while pairs finish their own step 1 draft. Point at the screen rather than reading the whole passage aloud.

While you finish, here is Ms. Rivera's, in full, so nobody has to imagine it. Her core artifact is one reading passage for her 6th grade food webs lesson, four sections, on grade level. Sections one and four are on the screen; two and three, producers and consumers, then decomposers, run the same way. Notice that it isn't polished. This is what eighty percent looks like, and it's enough to start from. Everything she builds for the rest of the lab comes out of this one passage.

SLIDE 22 Lab step 2: two directions

0:38

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her passage's two follow-ups, same chat: the support version, then the stretch.

⟶ 7 minutes. 45-min cut: one direction instead of two; let each teacher pick support or extension based on their roster.

Step two: differentiate it, two directions. First a support move: level it down or scaffold it, your choice, using the toolkit prompts on your handout. Then an extension move: stretch it with depth prompts. Two follow-up prompts in the same chat; the AI already has your artifact. This is the moment to notice the arithmetic: you are building the versions that used to cost an evening, inside seven minutes, for a lesson you're actually about to teach.

SLIDE 23 The prompt she types into the chat

0:39

⟶ Her full chat window is the slide, so the tracker chip steps aside here. Hold it up for a full minute; this is the slide people copy.

This is the whole lab on one screen. Same chat, her passage already in it, and the same four parts you learned in Kit 2: role in teal, task in navy, context in amber, format in green. Compare it to the "before" line at the top: "now make an easier version of that" would have got her something shorter and emptier. Look at what the context does, because it's the part people skip. She names the five words that have to survive: producer, consumer, decomposer, energy, ecosystem. That single sentence is what keeps a support version real science instead of baby talk. If you're stuck right now, copy this shape with your own artifact and you'll finish the lab.

SLIDE 24 Her iterations: what she typed next

0:41

⟶ Her chat thread is the slide, so no tracker chip here either. Read the right-hand column aloud; that's the payoff.

Iteration isn't failure; it's the work. Four follow-ups, one chat, nothing re-pasted, and each one is one of the four moves from earlier. Level it: rewrite it two years below, same sections, same key words. One passage became two. Scaffold it: five sentence starters and a worked example on a different topic, so the support version can be written from, not only read. Stretch it: three depth prompts for the students who finish in ten minutes, no extra practice problems. Reformat it: four station directions and eight discussion cards, so Tuesday can run as stations without a second planning night. That whole thread took her under seven minutes, which is exactly what you're doing right now.

SLIDE 25 Lab step 3: the 4-point review

0:45

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her passage's review, run live: one long sentence split, one example swapped.

⟶ 4 minutes. Insist on this step; skipping review is the failure mode of the whole kit. Ask pairs to swap and check each other's level labels.

Step three: run the 4-point review on all three versions. Accurate? At level, actually? Read a few sentences of the support version aloud to your partner; their ear is your first check. Fits your students? Sounds like you? Fix what fails, right now, while the chat is open. An artifact that passes all four is done. Not AI-done. Done done.

SLIDE 26 Her support version, in full

0:47

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her support version, finished: the same science, sentences a struggling reader can hold.

⟶ Hold this up while the last pairs finish their fixes. Read Section 1 aloud, then read the on-grade line at the bottom of the slide. The difference should be audible, not explained.

Here is the part we usually never show you: the thing itself. This is her support version, word for word, not a description of it. Listen to Section 1. "Every living thing needs energy. A food web maps where that energy goes. Producers make their own food." Now here is the same idea on grade level: "Consumers get their energy secondhand: a rabbit eats the grass, a hawk eats the rabbit." Same science. Same five words that this whole unit is about, and they are right there in the vocabulary box. What changed is the length of the sentences a struggling reader has to hold in their head at one time. That is the entire move. Not easier science. Same science, through a door they can get through.

SLIDE 27 Her stretch and stations, in full

0:48

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her stretch and her stations, finished: depth for some, a new shape for Tuesday.

⟶ Read station 2 aloud. It lands as the whole unit in one line.

The other two versions, also word for word. Three stretch prompts, and notice what none of them is: another worksheet. Draw a desert web and say where the energy starts. Find the error in a web with the arrows backwards. Explain it to a third grader. That is depth instead of volume, and it is the equity half of this hour, because the students who finish in ten minutes deserve planning too. Then the stations: the same content in a shape Tuesday can actually run. "Take one card out. List three things that change." All four versions passed her review, after two fixes. Hand-built, that set was an evening. On her screen it was under twenty minutes, and it is what she teaches Tuesday.

SLIDE 28 Share-out

0:48

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her share-out: what the review caught in her food webs passage, told first.

⟶ 3–4 voices, one minute each. 45-min cut: two voices. Prioritize anyone whose review caught a real problem.

Let's hear a few. What did you build, which direction surprised you, and did the review catch anything? If the AI got a level wrong or invented something, tell that story first; it's the most useful minute in the room.

SLIDE 29 What you just built

0:50

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her twenty minutes: one food webs passage became four teachable versions.

Look at what just happened. Nineteen minutes ago you had a lesson plan and good intentions. Now you have a core artifact, a support version, and an extension, all reviewed by the one person qualified to review them. Remember the meta-analysis from the top of the hour: differentiation works best embedded and technology-supported. That's not a description of some other school anymore. That's what's on your screen.

Segment 6 · Making it stick (slides 29–31)

SLIDE 30 One artifact a week
0:51

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her habit: one differentiated artifact a week. Small and steady.

Here's the habit that makes today compound: one differentiated artifact per week. Not a differentiated everything; that's how burnout dressed up as ambition. One lesson a week gets the full treatment: core, support, extension, review. In a semester that's fifteen lessons deep with materials for every kind of learner on your roster, built in the margins of time you already have. Small, steady, sustainable. That's the whole strategy.

SLIDE 31 Commitment #5
0:52

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her commitment #5: nothing reaches a student until the review passes.

Our running list grows by one. Kit 1 gave us three commitments; Kit 2 added the staff prompt doc. Today, commitment five: nothing AI-drafted reaches a student until it passes the 4-point review. Accurate, at level, fits, sounds like you. And when a differentiation prompt works, it goes in the staff doc with the others, so the fourth grade team isn't rebuilding what the third grade team perfected. Can I get a nod on that?

SLIDE 32 What's next
0:53

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her next kit: assessment. Rubrics and question banks from her notes.

Next in the series: Kit 4, AI for Assessment. Today you built the materials for the range of learners in your room; next time we build the ways to find out what they learned: question banks, rubrics, feedback that doesn't eat your Sunday. Your differentiated artifact from today comes with you; it's about to need an exit ticket.

Segment 7 · First 48 hours & close (slides 32–34)

SLIDE 33 Your first 48 hours
0:54

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her 48 hours: teach the support version, run one review, post one prompt.

Three small things within two days, each under fifteen minutes. Teach with what you built today, and jot one line about what the support kids and the stretch kids actually did. Level one more text for next week and run the quick level check on it. And post your best differentiation prompt to the staff doc. Tomorrow morning, coffee in hand, pick one.

SLIDE 34 Exit ticket
0:55

MS. RIVERA'S SCREEN · SO FAR Her exit ticket: the artifact built, the direction that surprised her.

⟶ *Distribute exit tickets; collect at the door. They're the school's PD documentation.*

Two minutes on the exit ticket: the move you'll use first, the artifact you built, and the differentiation task you still want help with. Your answers steer the follow-ups.

SLIDE 35 **Close** 0:56

Last word. Differentiation was never a good-intentions problem. It was a time problem. As of today, the time problem just got smaller. The knowing-your-kids part was always yours, and no tool touches it. Go teach the lesson you just planned. Thanks, everyone.
